Amazing journeys

TASK 1

Three journeys

In pairs, look at the photos. What transport are the people using? Where do you think they are going?

Photo A	Photo B	Photo C

TASK 2

Six words

Match the words to the meanings. Then **guess**: how is each word connected to the journeys?

1. **cow** _____
2. **rabbit** _____
3. **fence** _____
4. **oxygen** _____
5. **crash** _____
6. **experiment** _____

a. a scientific test to find out what happens
b. to hit something hard while you are moving
c. the gas in the air that we need to breathe
d. a wooden or wire structure around land
e. a small animal with long ears that digs holes
f. a large farm animal kept for milk and meat

Adapted from: Clare, A. and Wilson, JJ (2011) *Speakout Pre-Intermediate Students' Book*. Harlow: Pearson Education. Unit 5, lesson 5.1 'Amazing journeys', pp. 48–49. Tasks: Ramy Sakr, for Connect Lite (2026).

TASK 3

Read your text

You are A, B or C. Read **only your text**: quickly first (2 minutes). Were your guesses right? Then **read again** and answer your questions.

Student A · Apollo 13

Your text: Speakout Pre-Intermediate, lesson 5.1

1. Who made the journey?

2. Where did they go?

3. What problems did they have on the journey?

4. What happened at the end of the journey?

Student B · The Motorcycle Diaries

Your text: Speakout Pre-Intermediate, lesson 5.1

1. Who made the journey?

2. Where did they go?

3. What problems did they have on the journey?

4. What happened at the end of the journey?

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Student C · Rabbit-Proof Fence

Your text: Speakout Pre-Intermediate, lesson 5.1

1. Who made the journey?

2. Where did they go?

3. What problems did they have on the journey?

4. What happened at the end of the journey?

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TASK 4

The other two journeys

In groups of three, tell each other about your journey. Don't show your text! **Complete** the grid.

	A APOLLO 13	B THE MOTORCYCLE DIARIES	C RABBIT-PROOF FENCE
Who made the journey?			
Where did they go?			
What problems did they have?			
What happened at the end?			

TASK 5

Talk about it

In your group, discuss.

1. Which journey was the most amazing? Why?
2. Which journey was the most difficult? Why?
3. All three became films. Which would you most like to watch?

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TASK 6

While they were travelling...

Read the sentences about the journeys. **Answer** the questions with a partner.

1. While the astronauts were travelling to the moon, there was an explosion.
2. While Ernesto was travelling, he met many poor people.
3. The girls were walking through the desert when they saw the fence.

1. In sentence 1, which started first: the travelling or the explosion? _____
2. Which action was longer? _____
3. Was the travelling finished when the explosion happened? _____
4. Which tense is the longer action? _____
5. Which tense is the shorter action? _____

Longer action, in progress: was / were + verb-ing *they were travelling*

Shorter action, finished: past simple *something went wrong*

while + the longer action · **when** + either

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TASK 7

Past continuous or past simple?

Put the verbs in the right form.

1. While the astronauts _____ (travel) to the moon, an explosion _____ (destroy) important equipment.
2. Ernesto _____ (study) medicine when he _____ (decide) to travel across Latin America.
3. While Ernesto and Alberto _____ (ride) through South America, they _____ (crash) into a cow.
4. When it _____ (rain) one night, the three girls _____ (escape) from the camp.
5. While the girls _____ (walk) through the desert, they _____ (see) the fence.
6. The whole world _____ (watch) on TV when the astronauts _____ (land) safely in the ocean.

TASK 8

Your own journey

Think of a journey you remember: a holiday, a move, or a trip that went wrong. **Make notes**, then **tell your group**. Use *while* or *when* + past continuous at least twice. Whose journey was the most interesting?

Who?	
Where?	
Problems?	
The end?	

While I was waiting at the airport, I… · We were driving to… when the car… · In the end, we…

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